



This collection is a tribute to the "old" nail salons of the 2000s, with their nostalgic and comfortable atmosphere, before their transition into a more modern and minimalist style.



Nails of the 2000s



Color + Fabric

History

After the Vietnam War thousands of refugees fled the country to the US seeking a better life.

In 1975, Tippi Hedren was running a program for 20 Vietnamese refugee women to find work in the US. They admired her nails + how she cared for them. This gave Tippi the idea to get her manicurist, Dusty Coats, to teach these women how to do nails.

Tippi helped these women get certified to do nails + find work. Word soon spread throughout the Vietnamese community to get into the nail industry. From there, the Vietnamese American immigrant began entering + eventually dominating today's nail industry. Now, over half of the nail salons in the US are owned by Vietnamese individuals.

These salons are more than just a beauty business. They are cultural hub for our community. This is reflected in the design of many Vietnamese salons through traditional furniture and decor creating a unique + comfortable atmosphere for clients.



Tippi (to the left) brought her manicurist (below), to teach 20 Vietnamese women in California Refugee camp.



This collection seeks to capture the nail salons in the 2000s, the nostalgic, comfortable atmosphere they gave. Now, many salons have transitioned to sleek minimalism.



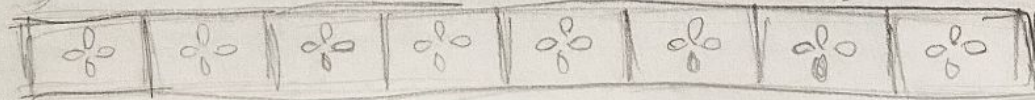
My Memory:

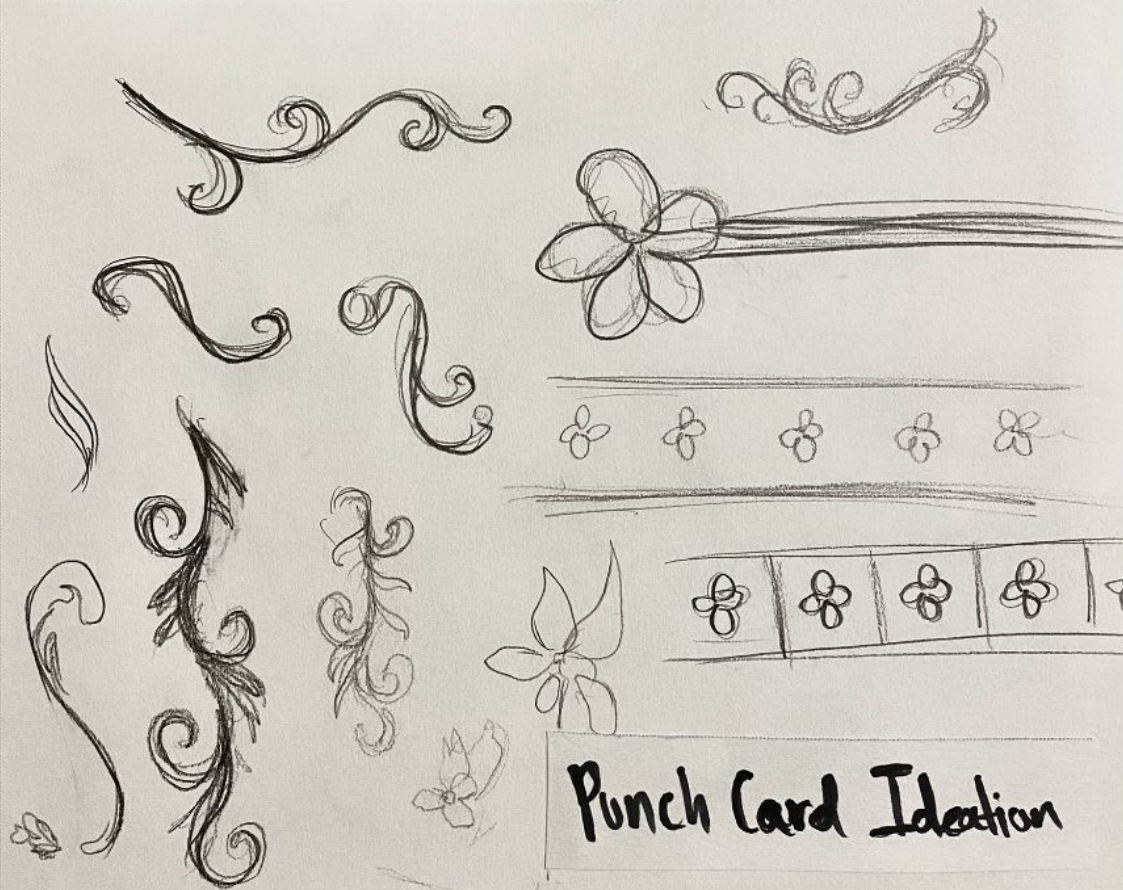
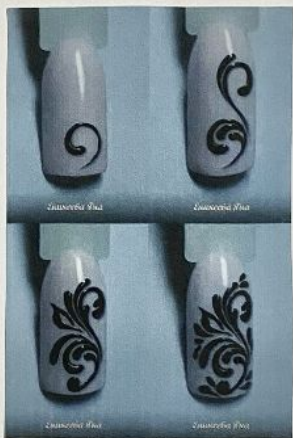
Growing up, I would go to the nail salon my mom worked at after school. I remember flowers, tiled floors, curtains to the over-filled small backroom, the smell of acetone, lots of vietnamese decor and buddhist altar, the comfy couch customers would wait at, and of course all the nail polish and supplies.



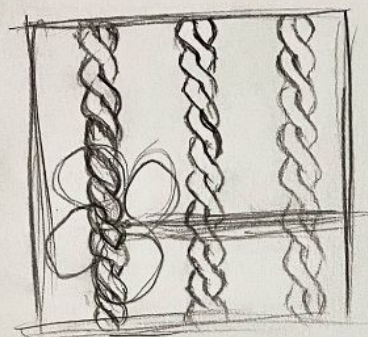
This collection preserves the "old" nail salons and the culture that was captured in it.

Focus: Nostalgia, flowers, swirl motifs, and tiled floors.

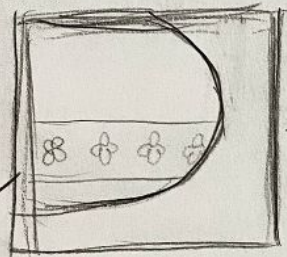




Punch Card Ideation



cable = comfort
nail salon = comfort



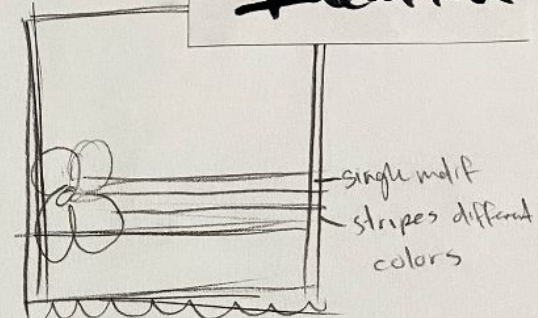
like tiles

partial knit
with fairisle
flower design stripe
inside

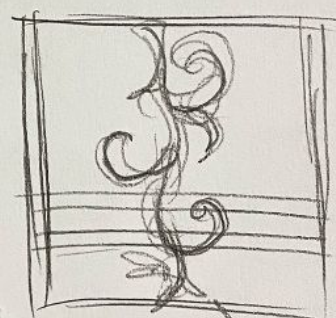


plating!

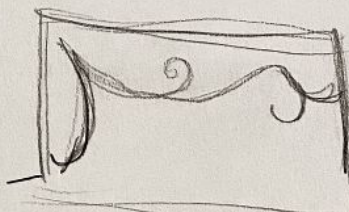
Ideation



picot hem
cute nostalgic
like flower petals
& nail designs



single motif
on stripes
or punch
lace no
stripes



swirl motif

